Family is a more or less durable association of husband and wife with or without child or of a man or woman alone with children.

-Nimkoff

Characteristics Of Family

Universality: Malinowski writes the typical family a group consisting of mother, father and their progeny is found in all communities, savage, barbarians and civilized.

Emotional basis: It is built upon sentiments of love, affection, sympathy, cooperation and friendship.

Limited size: The family is smaller in size. It is a smallest social unit.

Formative influence: It shapes the personality and molds the character of its members.

Responsibility of the members: The members of the family has certain responsibilities, duties and obligations.

Social regulation: The society takes precaution to safeguard this organization from any possible breakdown.

Types of The Family

Based on Birth

Family of Orientation: The family in which an individual is born is his family of orientation his family of orientation.

Family of Procreation: The family where an individual sets up after his/her marriage is his/her family of procreation.

Based on Marriage

Monogamous Family: This family consists of one husband and wife, including children and is based on monogamous marriages.

Polygynous Family: A family consisting of one husband, and more than one wife, and all the children born to all the wives or adopted by each of them.

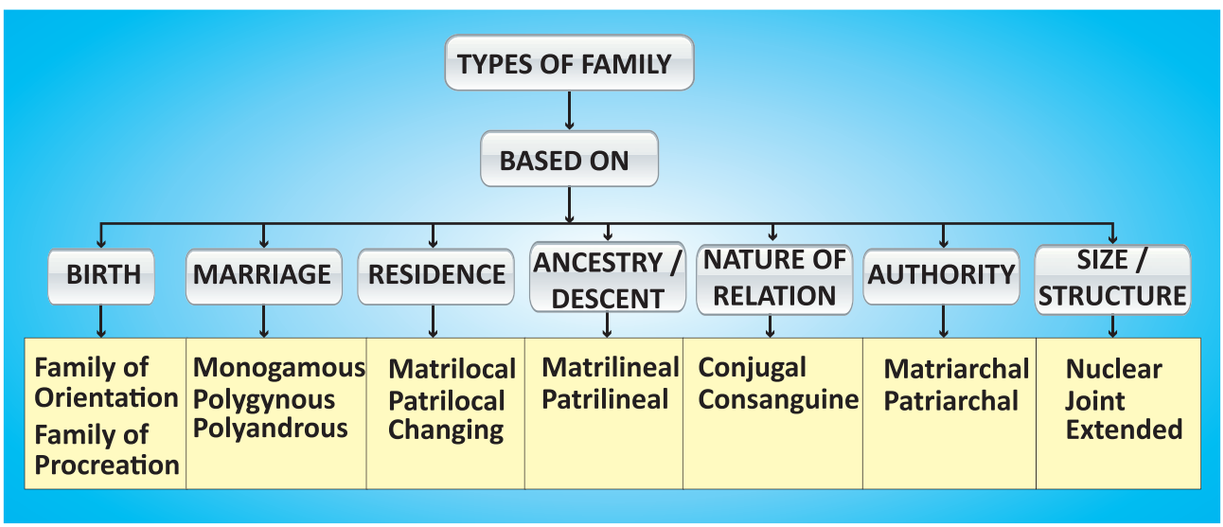
Polyandrous Family: A family made up of one wife and more than one husband, and the children, either born or adopted with each one of them.

Based on Residence

Family of Matrilocal Residence: When a couple stays in the wife's house, the family is known as family of matrilocal residence.

Family of Patrilocal Residence: When a family stays in the house of husband, the family is known as family of patrilocal residence.

Family of Changing Residence: When a family stays in the husband's house for some time, and moves to wife's house, stays there for a period of time, and then moves back to husband's parents, or starts living in another place, the family is called a family of changing residence.



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